PROPOSED POLICY REVISIONS

Information Item

Rationale: Legislation passed in 2020 requiring ~~all~~ K-12 public schools to provide comprehensive sexual health education to all students by the 2022-2023 school year. The legislation defines comprehensive sexual health education as "recurring instruction in human development and reproductions that is medically accurate, age-appropriate, and inclusive of all students." For K-3 instruction is defined as social and emotional learning (SEL) that is consistent with Washington' Social Emotional Learning Benchmarks. Instruction for grades 4-12 will continue to include HIV/AIDS prevention. Parents continue to have the right to opt their children out of comprehensive sexual health education instruction.

The new law requires comprehensive sexual health education ~~to be provided~~ at several points during the K-12 experience. The first step in implementing the new law is for districts to review and adopt a comprehensive sexual health education curriculum. Beginning in the 2021-22 school year, all schools serving students in grades 6-12 ~~should~~ must ~~be providing~~provide comprehensive sexual health education twice in grades 6-8 and twice in grade 9-12.

Beginning in the 2022-2023 school year, all schools must provide Social Emotional Learning at least once to students in grades K-3. Also in the 2022-2023 school year, students in grades 4-5 must receive comprehensive sexual health education at least once. The district's policy is updated to reflect the district's implementation of the state's new comprehensive sexual health requirements.

Comprehensive Sexual Health Education

The ~~Board of Directors of~~ Vancouver Public Schools Board of Directors ~~is authorized by law to determine whether sexual health education instruction will be offered in the district. The board~~ has determined that all students will be provided instruction in comprehensive sexual health education ~~such a program will be offered to students~~, consistent with state law.

Comprehensive ~~S~~sexual health education instruction provided ~~offered~~ by the district to students in grades 4-12 will be medically and scientifically accurate, and inclusive of ~~appropriate for the age of~~ students, ~~appropriate for students~~ regardless of~~-~~ their protected class status under RCW Chapter 49.60.~~gender, race, disability status, or sexual orientation, and include information about abstinence and other methods of preventing unintended pregnancy and sexually transmitted diseases~~. Abstinence will not be taught to the exclusion of other instruction on contraceptives and disease prevention. The district's sexual health education program will be consistent with the *Guidelines for Sexual Health Information and Disease Prevention* developed by the Department of Health and the Office of Superintendent of Public Instruction, the Health Education K-12 Learning Standards adopted by OSPI, and other provisions of RCW 28A.300.475.

Instructional materials will be chosen from a list provided by OSPI or will be identified or developed by the district and reviewed using comprehensive sexual health education curriculum analysis tools provide by OSPI.~~.~~

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The superintendent or designee will provide parents/guardians an opportunity to review the materials to be used, or provide electronic access, and will ~~and~~ provide information on and grant all requests for excluding their child from sexual health education instruction~~, and will grant all such requests~~.

The superintendent or their designee will annually identify to OSPI any curricula used to provide comprehensive sexual health education and describe how classroom instruction aligns with legislative requirements.

Legal References:

RCW 28A.300.475
RCW 28A.600.480(2)
WAC 392-410-140
RCW 28A.305.130 (6) (8)
RCW 28A.230.020
RCW 28A.320.040
RCW 28A.330.100 (5)
RCW 28A.405.060
RCW 28A.405.030
RCW 28A.230.070
WAC 180-44-010 (1) (2)
WAC 180-50-140

Adopted: May 8, 2018

Revised: _____

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